videos and animations. An example is the Macromedia Flash plugin, which allows you to watch Flash animations.

❍ **JavaScript:** A language used to develop active content for Web sites. For example, JavaScript programs certain images on Web pages to change into other images as the mouse cursor is moved over them.

❍ **Cookies:** Text files on your computer that store data used by Web sites. Cookies can contain any form of information that the Web sites have designed for them.

You're now ready to get your browser secure.

8.1.2 Microsoft Internet Explorer

IE is one of the most popular browsers, mostly because it comes bundled with Windows. Since a large number of individuals use this browser, a large number of hackers make it their target. IE makes use of ActiveX content, and this, in a large number of cases, makes it very vulnerable to outside attack. Ideally, you should disable all features that have the smallest chance of placing your computer at risk. However, here are some smarter options.

The first thing you should do is to check your IE security settings. You can access this option from **Tools > Internet Options > Security**. If you are an average Internet user and have a decent anti-virus on your



You can choose a security level depending on the type of internet usage